

The Natural Heritage Trust (NHT) is the Australian Government’s key investment platform for achieving its natural resource management, sustainable agriculture and environmental protection outcomes.

Through the NHT the Australian Government has established the \$302.1 million Climate-Smart Agriculture Program over five years from 2023-24 to 2027-2028. This program will drive agricultural sustainability, productivity, and competitiveness. It supports the following program outcomes:

- The agriculture sector is adopting practices to reduce emissions and build resilience to climate change.
- The agriculture sector is supported to harness carbon and biodiversity incentives and implement industry sustainability frameworks.
- Farmers are supported to drive agricultural growth, while adopting sustainable natural resource management practices that protect and conserve natural capital and biodiversity.

All Climate-Smart Agriculture Program funding has been committed.

The Climate-Smart Agriculture Program is comprised of the following investment streams:

Partnerships and Innovation

Partnerships and Innovation grants are providing a total of \$45 million in funding over 4 years (2024-25 to 2027-28) through an open-competitive grant round for medium to large scale projects to drive the development, trialling, adoption and roll-out of climate-smart, sustainable, innovative tools and on-ground farm practices that increase the agriculture sector’s productivity and profitability.

The Partnerships and Innovation grant round opened for applications on 22 February 2024 and closed 8 April 2024.

Partnerships & Innovation – List of successful applicants

Recipient legal entity name	State	Project/activity title	Funding
The Mulloon Institute Limited	National	The Landscape Function Toolkit. Equipping Australia with a Systems-Approach to Landscape Climate Resilience.	\$3,796,700

Grower Group Alliance Inc.	National	The Ripple Effect. A national, grower-led collaboration to increase biodiversity and reduce emissions via the demonstration and accelerated adoption of best-practice water management, strengthening farm water security, productivity and sustainability.	\$5,000,000
The University of Western Australia	WA, SA, VIC, NSW, QLD	Pasture diversification and management to promote climate resistance and resilience.	\$4,964,936
Living Knowledge Indigenous Corporation	NQLD	Increasing climate resilience, ecosystem health and agricultural profitability in Queensland grazing landscapes with Cultural Fire management and traditional plant knowledge.	\$4,937,057
Southern Gulf NRM Ltd	NWQLD	Improving land condition across Northwest Queensland to boost productivity, build climate resilience and increase biodiversity.	\$5,000,000
Healthy Land and Water Ltd	QLD	Building resilient and productive grazing landscapes through the adoption of climate-smart practices and engagement with natural capital markets, industry driven environmental credentials and sustainability frameworks.	\$1,867,258
The Queensland University of Technology	NSW, QLD	Climate Smart Cotton - reducing nitrous oxide emissions with enhanced efficiency fertilisers.	\$1,985,000
Cotton Research and Development Corporation	TAS, NSW, QLD	Advancing the adoption of climate-smart, innovative irrigation control technology for the cotton and dairy industries.	\$1,249,069
Adelaide University	SA, NSW, TAS, WA, VIC	Innovative Soil Technologies to Foster Resilience and Climate Smart Crop Production in Australia.	\$4,951,000
Charles Sturt University	NSW, VIC	Developing practices for profitable, sustainable sheep production in a variable climate.	\$2,236,249
Australian Wool Innovation Limited	National	Australian Wool Insetting Project.	\$4,086,000
James Cook University	National	Rejuvenating agricultural soils to enhance productivity, resilience and carbon sequestration using enhanced rock weathering.	\$4,877,768

For more information, please visit the [GrantConnect](#) website.

Capacity Building

Capacity Building grants are providing up to \$25.5 million in funding over 4 years (2024-25 to 2027-28). Funding will be distributed through two open-competitive grant rounds. These grants aim to strengthen community efforts in sustainable agriculture and natural resource management practices. The goal of the grants is to drive on-ground adoption. The grants build on the success of existing climate-smart, sustainable agriculture projects, initiatives and information sources.

Round 1

Capacity Building Round 1 opened for applications on 22 February 2024 and closed 28 March 2024. Up to \$9 million in funding was made available through the round.

Successful applicants funded through this round are listed below.

Recipient legal entity name	State	Project/activity title	Funding
The Mulloon Institute Limited	NSW	Water Stewardship for Climate resilience - Nurturing skills for First Nations / Farmer collaborations.	\$998,300
Narrabri Local Aboriginal Land Council	NSW	Climate-smart Gomeroi grain and food production with regenerative agriculture.	\$768,986
Bass Coast Landcare Network Inc	VIC	Creating climate-smart communities - building awareness, knowledge and skills to increase the capacity of the agricultural sector and First Nations people in West and South Gippsland to transition to a sustainable, climate- smart future.	\$641,770
Geographe Catchment Council Incorporated	WA	Geographe Resilient Farms - Geographe Farmers protecting Geographe Bay (GFPGB) by implementing climate- smart and sustainable agriculture practices.	\$498,100
Mimal Land Management Aboriginal Corporation	NT	Mimal First Nations-led whole of community approach to build, test, and pilot knowledge resources and decision-making tools to guide the transition from buffalo enterprises to nature capital markets in Arnhem Land and to scale.	\$728,694
Mallee Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Increasing the capacity of Mallee farmers to identify and adopt climate-smart farming practices with innovative soil mapping tools.	\$597,600
Stirlings to Coast Farmers Inc.	WA	Improving farmers' knowledge and capacity to increase nitrogen use efficiency and reduce grain crop carbon emissions through optimised rotations and in-season nitrogen strategies in the highly inefficient high rainfall zone of Western Australia.	\$589,457

Accounting For Nature Limited	National	Empowering Regions, Agricultural Industries, and First Nations with Trusted Environmental Accounting Solutions through Accounting for Nature.	\$999,140
The University of Queensland	NT	Enhancing soil health and climate resilience in the Northern Territory.	\$996,139
Local Land Services	NSW	Water wise for the future - Community-led learning for productive, sustainable and future climate ready intensive irrigation industries.	\$871,574
West Gippsland Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Cultivating Connections - First Nations peoples and farmers collaborating for Climate-Smart Agriculture.	\$368,700
Northern Australia Aboriginal Kakadu Plum Alliance Co- operative Limited	NT, WA	Wild harvest & Kakadu Plum cultivar capacity development project.	\$334,848
Wheatbelt Natural Resource Management Incorporated	WA	Wheatbelt land-use paradigms - navigating new industries in the low carbon and natural capital era.	\$522,011

Round 2

Capacity Building Round 2 opened for applications on 18 February 2025 and closed on 31 March 2025. Up to \$16.58 million in funding was made available through the round.

The objectives of the Capacity Building Grants Round 2 are to support farmers to have better access to knowledge and skills relating to best practice climate-smart sustainable agriculture approaches.

The grants fund projects that:

- increase awareness, knowledge and skills of best practice climate-smart sustainable agriculture approaches
- assist community organisations, Landcare groups, First Nations peoples and industry to support farmers and land holders adopt climate-smart and sustainable agriculture practices
- provide opportunities, initiatives and information resources to assist the agriculture sector to increase adoption of climate-smart and sustainable agriculture practices at scale.

Successful applicants funded through this round are listed below.

Recipient legal entity name	State	Project/activity title	Funding
-----------------------------	-------	------------------------	---------

Soils for Life Pty Ltd	National	Orchard Resilience - Collaboratively delivering context-specific climate-smart practices and impacts across four key perennial horticulture regions in Australia.	\$1,451,976
West Pine	TAS	Carbon that Counts: Increasing understanding on implications for profitability and productivity from sustainable and climate-smart practice change for the agricultural sector.	\$610,517
West Hume Landcare Inc	NSW	Linking land management, dryland salinity and soil health in the Eastern Murray Catchment.	\$376,777.93
Central West Farming Systems Incorporated	National	Improved decision making for climate-smart flock management.	\$2,032,734
Adelaide University	NSW, WA	Smart grazing, stronger lands - building grazing and land management capacity across Australia's southern rangelands.	\$2,676,003
Ricegrowers Limited	NSW	Sustainable Rice Farming - Enhancing biodiversity in the context of reduced water availability.	\$1,836,288
Sheep Producers Australia Limited	National	Climate Smart Sheep - building industry capacity across the supply chain (Green Sheep).	\$2,997,200
Wine Industry Association of Western Australia (Inc) (Wines of Western Australia)	WA	Western Australian Wine Sustainability Advancement Program (WAWSAP).	\$2,130,337.95
Soils for Life Pty Ltd	National	Dairy Resilience - Supporting a critical mass of farmers to move from curiosity to confidence in adopting climate-smart soil health practices for social, economic and environmental resilience.	\$1,338,938
Upper Barwon Landcare Network Inc.	VIC	Leading farmer adoption of sustainable agriculture for climate resilience.	\$1,070,867

For more information, please visit the [GrantConnect](#) website.

Small Grants

Small Grants are providing up to \$2.5 million in funding over 2 years (2024-25 to 2026-27) through an open-competitive grant round for on-ground projects led by a range of community groups, Landcare groups, First Nations groups and research organisations.

These small grants will support the adoption of climate-smart, sustainable agriculture practices that:

- improve management of our natural resources

- build resilience to climate change
- increase on-farm productivity.

The Small Grants round opened for applications on 30 April 2024 and closed 4 June 2024.

Successful applicants funded through this grant round are listed below.

Recipient legal entity name	State	Project/activity title	Funding
Chestnuts Australia Inc.	VIC, NSW, TAS	Management of orchard and landscape micro-organism biodiversity with variable climatic conditions to ensure ongoing viability of major production regions for nut crops.	\$100,000
University of Tasmania	TAS	Circular nutrient economies for climate resilient soils.	\$99,826
Kiewa Catchment Landcare Groups Incorporated	VIC	Futureproofing farms for climate resilience in the Kiewa Catchment.	\$99,970
Outback Academy Australia Limited	WA	First Nations Climate Smart Agriculture - Outback Academy Australia, Follow the Flowers WA.	\$100,000
Mallee Catchment Management Authority	VIC	More Grain per Drop of Rain - Increasing the yield potential of Mallee dryland cropping systems in a drying climate.	\$100,000
Mallee Sustainable Farming Inc.	VIC, NSW, SA	Driving on-farm adoption of carbon-friendly soil management practices adaptive to climate change impacts across the Mallee region of southern Australia.	\$98,000
Holbrook Landcare Group	NSW	Climate Smart Revegetation Plots on Farms in the Holbrook Landcare Network Region.	\$100,000
Soil Regen Solutions Pty Ltd	VIC	Driving Climate-Smart Agriculture for Wimmera Broadacre Farmers Through Collaborative Discussion Groups and Peer Influence.	\$84,100
Southern Farming Systems Ltd	VIC, TAS	Enhancing Agricultural Productivity and Climate Resilience Through Sustainable Soil Acidity Management Practices - A Collaborative Approach Leveraging Advanced Tools, Extension Services, and Local Expertise.	\$99,749
Bass Coast Landcare Network Inc.	VIC	Creating Climate Smart Farms in Bass Coast through Climate Adaptation Planning, Emissions Reduction Planning and community education.	\$98,095
Future Farmers SA Incorporated	SA	Regenerating the Hills and Fleurieu Region.	\$71,456
The Wheen Bee Foundation Limited	National	Pollinator Stewardship Program - Improving the adoption of best practice land management strategies and	\$100,000

		techniques to increase pollinator abundance and biodiversity	
		nationally on Australian farms, public parks and private lands.	
Outback Academy Australia Limited	VIC	First Nations Climate Smart Agriculture, Outback Academy Australia, Follow the Flowers Regenerative Farmers Alliance, Victoria.	\$100,000
Young Farmers Connect Inc.	VIC, NSW, QLD, SA, ACT	Small Farms Count - place based Climate Smart land management for small scale farms.	\$80,500
Western Port Catchment Landcare Network Inc.	VIC	Farmers digging deeper to grow stronger through supportive peer networks in Gippsland.	\$100,000
Wodonga Urban Landcare Network Inc.	VIC	Expanding Healthy Hectares in North East Victoria.	\$94,416
Hazelnut Growers of Australia Inc.	VIC	National Expansion of Adaptation to Nut Farming Trial - Managing Water and Soil in a Changing Climate.	\$100,000
Irrigation Research & Extension Committee	NSW	Improving irrigation management via demonstrations, training and use of technology for horticulture farmers to better manage their natural capital and increase their knowledge and skills.	\$100,000
Weddin Landcare Steering Committee Incorporated	NSW	'Over the Fence' - Connecting farmers with farmers and other experts to increase local adoption of climate-smart agricultural practices in the Weddin district.	\$94,700
Buchananco Pty Ltd	QLD	Demonstrating the real benefits of cover cropping in intensive horticulture on Kambuwal land, the Granite Belt region of Queensland.	\$97,500
South Gippsland Landcare Network Inc.	VIC	Climate-smart farm planning for South Gippsland.	\$92,740
Gippsland Agricultural Group Incorporated	VIC	Gippsland 250 Climate Smart, Soil Smart. Enhancing sustainable agriculture, reducing emissions, and conserving biodiversity through education, networking, and expert support for 250 farmers and the Lake Tyers Aboriginal Trust.	\$100,000
Delta Agribusiness Pty Ltd	NSW	Deep soil amelioration to increase agricultural productivity and Soil Carbon levels in northern NSW.	\$95,000

Barossa Australia
Incorporated SA

Encouraging Reluctant Farmers to Adopt Sustainable
Winegrowing Practices Utilising Non-Typical Champions \$100,000
and Focused Regional Support.

For more information, please visit the [GrantConnect](#) website.

Soil Capacity Building

The Soil Capacity Building grants are comprised of two grant rounds:

- \$6.26 million for a team of [Regional Soils Coordinators](#) (closed non-competitive)
- \$2.14 million for a National Soils Community of Practice (restricted-competitive).

These grants are supporting networks for researchers, primary producers, and community groups to work together, and provide a forum for soil practitioners to share the latest soil science information and tools.

The targeted application process for both grant opportunities opened on 7 February 2024 and closed on 5 March 2024.

Soil Health Information

The government is also continuing to invest in soil through:

- \$21.6 million for a National Soil Monitoring Program to understand the condition and trends of soils nationally. The data will support stakeholders to make evidence-based decisions to improve soil health at a range of scales and will be made available publicly through the Australian National Soil Information System.
- \$6 million to enhance Australian National Soil Information System (ANSIS) to provide improved access, sharing, and use of nationally consistent soil data and information to help sustainably manage our soil, and to support decision-making and policy outcomes.

Regional Delivery Partners and Landcare

The Climate-Smart Agriculture Program also recognises the vital role that Regional Delivery Partners and National Landcare organisations provide in achieving sustainable agriculture and natural resource management outcomes. The following investment streams will support this:

- \$14.5 million for Supporting National Landcare Organisations - operational funding – to support our National Landcare Organisations to maintain their capacity, and ensure they are primed to deliver NHT outcomes efficiently and at scale. This funding is provided by both the Department of Agriculture, Fisheries and Forestry, and the Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water.

- \$27.1 million for Regional Delivery Partner operational funding – to support the operational capacity of a national network of Regional Delivery Partners to deliver NHT outcomes efficiently and at scale.
- \$85.6 million for Regional Delivery Partner project funding – for Regional Delivery Partners to initiate practical, on-ground, climate-smart, sustainable agriculture projects across 52 regions in Australia.
- \$40.7 million for Sustainable Agriculture Facilitators – to provide a national network of facilitators employed by each of the Regional Delivery Partners. The facilitators will connect farmers, landholders, community groups and agriculture industries to relevant information and programs on climate-smart, sustainable agriculture practices; facilitate partnerships and connections; and support the delivery of sustainable agriculture projects in their region.

These investments will also strengthen First Nations engagement and participation to enable the agriculture sector to draw benefits from traditional knowledge and support First Nations agricultural enterprise.

Through the program's effective on-ground projects, the government will support farmers to manage climate risks and invest in their on-farm natural capital and effective natural resources management, helping the sector to respond to climate change, better withstand future bushfires, floods and droughts and protect its productivity.

National Landcare Organisation Funding

Landcare Australia Limited	\$8,905,265.75
National Landcare Network	\$6,061,567.45

The following projects were funded through the Whole of Government Panel of [Regional Delivery Partners](#):

Regional delivery partner name	State	Project activity/title	Funding
Environment Planning and Sustainable Development Directorate	ACT	Regenerating Farms/Rehydrating Landscapes - Planning for Success	\$513,185
Territory Natural Resource Management	NT	Climate smart agricultural practices in the Northern Territory	\$2,331,484
Local Land Services (South East)	NSW	Climate Smart Agriculture: Integrating local knowledge for enhanced decision-making and resilience	\$1,300,142
Local Land Services (Central West)	NSW	Adapt 2- Optimising resources for enhanced production	\$971,526
Local Land Services (Central Tablelands)	NSW	FARM - Farmers Adapt to Risks and Markets	\$1,283,765
	NSW	Hunter Climate Smart Farming Network	\$947,395

Local Land Services
(Hunter)

Local Land Services (Riverina)	NSW	Building a Climate-Smart Agriculture Future for the Riverina	\$2,190,685
Local Land Services (Murray)	NSW	Improving soil condition and management practice in the Murray region	\$1,517,785
Local Land Services (North West NSW)	NSW	Valuing Natural Assets on Farms in the North West	\$641,449
Local Land Services (Greater Sydney)	NSW	Harvesting Tomorrow: Boosting Agricultural Sustainability and Productivity in Greater Sydney	\$906,591
Local Land Services (North Coast)	NSW	North Coast Climate Smart Agriculture	\$1,861,880
Local Land Services (Northern Tablelands)	NSW	Growing Climate Smart Agriculture in the Northern Tablelands	\$1,535,625
Local Land Services (Western)	NSW	Sustainable Productive Landscapes - Western Connections	\$2,212,509
Healthy Land and Water Ltd	QLD	Building Climate Smart & Productive Agricultural Landscapes in South East Queensland	\$1,506,776
FNQ NRM Ltd	QLD	Climate-Smart Farming in the Wet Tropics: Supporting a shift to better practices	\$1,322,888
Reef Catchments Mackay Whitsunday Isaac Limited	QLD	Supporting Mackay Whitsunday Isaac graziers adopt climate-smart practices to protect and conserve on-farm natural capital	\$1,029,992
Fitzroy Basin Association Limited	QLD	Creating Climate Smart Agricultural Business	\$1,239,860
Burnett Mary Regional Group for Natural Resource Management	QLD	Climate Smart Catchments: Transforming Agriculture Across Burnett Mary	\$1,297,868
NQ Dry Tropics Ltd	QLD	Burdekin Productive Pastures Project	\$1,482,962
Northern Gulf Resource Management Group Ltd	QLD	Climate Smart Agriculture in the Northern Gulf	\$486,324
Northern Gulf Resource Management Group Ltd	QLD	Building Climate Smart & Productive Agricultural Landscapes in the Gulf Savannah	\$486,324
Southern Queensland Natural Resources Management	QLD	Growing Climate Smart Grazing in the Condamine River Basin	\$2,042,059
Cape York Natural Resource Management	QLD	Cultivating Climate Smart and Sustainable Agriculture in Cape York Peninsula	\$1,506,697
Desert Channels Queensland	QLD		\$1,442,085

		Reducing biosecurity threats to sustainable agriculture from climate change in Desert Channels Region	
Southern Gulf NRM	QLD	Climate Resilient Agriculture in Southern Gulf: Supporting Landholders Managing Climatic Change	\$908,517
Limestone Coast Landscape Board	SA	Limestone Coast Climate-smart Landscapes	\$1,079,533
Murraylands and Riverland Landscape Board	SA	Identifying and Harnessing Opportunities for Resilient and Adaptive Agricultural Systems	\$2,319,393
South Australian Arid Lands Landscape Board	SA	Building Pastoral Sustainability by identifying, enhancing and conserving natural resources	\$1,349,504
Hills And Fleurieu Landscape Board	SA	Climate Smart Farm Action Planning	\$871,711
Northern And Yorke Landscape Board	SA	ACE Farmers: Adapting to Climate and Emissions	\$2,169,867
Eyre Peninsula Landscape Board	SA	Sustainable Agriculture: Driving growth through innovation and climate responsive practices	\$1,997,886
Kangaroo Island Landscape Board	SA	Kangaroo Island - Farming towards the Future	\$725,532
Alinytjara Wilurara Landscape Board	SA	Sustainable pastoral development in the Anangu Pitjantjatjara Yankunytjatjara (APY) and Yalata pastoral areas, South Australia	\$1,934,609
Cradle Coast Authority	TAS	Our Natural Advantage – building the benefits of natural capital on farms	\$940,544
Southern Regional Natural Resource Management Association	TAS	Integrating Agricultural and Environmental Practices for Sustainable Farming Systems in Southern Tasmania	\$1,400,870
Northern Tasmanian Natural Resource Management Association	TAS	On-farm Natural Capital and Market Readiness	\$1,612,004
Wimmera Catchment Authority	VIC	On farm natural capital and Climate-Smart communities of practice	\$1,864,916
Mallee Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Mallee Sustainable Agriculture Services	\$2,223,198
Glenelg Hopkins Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Sustainable Farms. Sustainable Futures.	\$2,169,755
Corangamite Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Diverse Farms Resilient Catchments - growing diversity and resilience on-farms, in communities and across landscapes	\$1,979,758

Goulburn Broken Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Nature-based environmental services for sustainable agriculture in the Goulburn Broken - Nature Services for Ag	\$2,298,015
East Gippsland Catchment Management Authority	VIC	TopSoils3	\$1,872,826
North East Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Climate Smart Agriculture in north-east Victoria	\$1,534,508
West Gippsland Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Climate Smart Farmers in West Gippsland	\$1,613,888
Melbourne Water Corporation	VIC	Project Ag-Resilience: benchmarking agroecology credentials and climate smart practices in Melbourne's Foodbowl	\$1,881,167
North Central Catchment Management Authority	VIC	Climate Positive Farming Initiative (C+FI) - North Central Victoria	\$1,902,544
Perth Region NRM Inc	WA	Improving Agricultural Productivity by Restoring Natural Capital in the Swan Region	\$1,182,518
Wheatbelt Natural Resource Management Incorporated	WA	Forage for Nature	\$1,300,306
Peel Harvey Catchment Council Inc	WA	Future Ready Farming	\$1,172,794
Northern Agricultural Catchments Council Incorporated	WA	Future Farm Foundations	\$2,213,043
South West NRM	WA	Farm efficiencies and sustainability towards (FEaST) 2030	\$1,649,131
South Coast Natural Resource Management Inc	WA	Future-Ready South Coast: Empowering Farmers to Navigate Climate Change and Strengthen Natural Capital	\$2,120,946
Rangelands NRM Co-ordinating Group	WA	Building pastoral and landscape resiliency in the Western Australian Rangelands: Communities uniting and harnessing their ingenuity	\$1,076,528.50
Aboriginal Biodiversity Foundation	WA	Capacity Building Program for Farmers and Land Managers in the Rangelands of Western Australia	\$965,530.50

Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning

Monitoring and reporting allows for effective tracking of progress and measurement. This assists the department to evaluate how its Natural Heritage Trust (NHT) investments are performing against program and project outcomes.

The Climate-Smart Agriculture Program (CSAP) Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning (MEL) Framework focuses on understanding the impact of the program, including what works, why it works, and who benefits from it. This approach embeds an evaluative culture that values ongoing learning and improvement.

The MEL Framework:

- sets out how the CSAP and its investments will be measured and evaluated
- supports measuring CSAP's progress and achievements over time
- helps identify improvements for the future.

The CSAP MEL Framework applies to programs focussed on sustainable agriculture initiatives funded under the NHT.

For further information contact NHTengagement@aff.gov.au.

Further information

The previous phase of the NHT was comprised of [\\$1 billion for Phase 2 of the National Landcare Program](#), which funded a range of natural resource management projects to June 2023.

This webpage will be updated regularly over the duration of the Climate-Smart Agriculture Program (current phase of the NHT).

Contact us

We'd love to hear from you, email NHTprograms@aff.gov.au.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/agriculture-land/farm-food-drought/natural-resources/landcare/climate-smart>